MIRIAM A. HALVORSEN

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ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

2022 – present **Assistant Professor**, *University of Edinburgh*, Edinburgh, UK
School of Philosophy, Psychology and Language Sciences. Affiliate, Centre for Language Evolution.

2019 – 2022 **Postdoctoral Research Fellow**, *Max Planck Institute for Psycholinguistics*, Nijmegen, NL
Language and Cognition Department. Supervisor: Prof. A. Wierzbicka.

2018 – 2019 **Visiting Scholar**, *University of California, Berkeley*, Berkeley, CA

EDUCATION

2019 **Ph.D., Linguistics**, *University of Oslo*, Oslo, NO
Dissertation: *Statistical learning and the emergence of morphological paradigms.*
Committee: J. Nordgård (chair), P. Svenonius, K. Tamminen.

2014 **M.Phil., Theoretical Linguistics**, *University of Cambridge*, Cambridge, UK
Distinction. Thesis: *Frequency effects in Norwegian compound stress.*

2012 **B.A., Philosophy and Linguistics**, *University of Bergen*, Bergen, NO
Summa cum laude.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Language acquisition and statistical learning; morphological productivity; computational models of the lexicon; cross-linguistic corpus methods; the relationship between usage frequency and grammatical structure.

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

6. **Halvorsen, M. A.**, Okonkwo, C., & Lindqvist, T. (2026). Paradigm uniformity as a learning bias: evidence from artificial language experiments. *Cognition*, 251, 105–721.
5. Lindqvist, T., & **Halvorsen, M. A.** (2025). Frequency, productivity and the shape of the Norwegian verbal lexicon. *Journal of Linguistics*, 61(2), 287–319.
4. **Halvorsen, M. A.** (2024). What children do not learn: negative evidence and morphological overregularisation. *Language*, 100(1), 44–78.
3. **Halvorsen, M. A.**, & Wierzbicka, A. (2023). Distributional learning without distributional statistics. *Cognitive Science*, 47(9), e13–302.
2. Okonkwo, C., **Halvorsen, M. A.**, & Reyes, D. (2022). A cross-linguistic corpus study of compound stress. *Linguistic Typology*, 26(3), 501–540.
1. **Halvorsen, M. A.** (2021). Morphological paradigms are not stored whole. *Journal of Memory and Language*, 118, 104–198.

Book Chapters

2. **Halvorsen, M. A.** (2025). Statistical learning. In R. Ashworth & Y. Sun (Eds.), *The Cambridge Handbook of Language Acquisition* (pp. 212–241). Cambridge University Press.
1. **Halvorsen, M. A.**, & Nordgård, J. (2022). Scandinavian morphology in contact. In P. Svenonius (Ed.), *Nordic Grammar* (pp. 88–117). Oxford University Press.

Manuscripts Under Review

- **Halvorsen, M. A.**, & Reyes, D. Learners track types, not tokens: a reanalysis of four artificial-grammar studies. *Under review at Psychological Review.*
- Okonkwo, C., & **Halvorsen, M. A.** Productivity without transparency. *Revise and resubmit, Language.*

GRANTS AND FELLOWSHIPS

2025 – 2029 **ERC Starting Grant**, *European Research Council*
Learning Without Rules: The Statistical Foundations of Morphology (€1,498,000). Principal Investigator.

2023 – 2025 **Leverhulme Research Project Grant**, *Leverhulme Trust*
£248,000. Co-Investigator with T. Lindqvist.

2019 – 2022 **Marie Skłodowska-Curie Individual Fellowship**, *European Commission*
€187,000.

2015 – 2019 **Doctoral Research Fellowship**, *Research Council of Norway*

HONOURS AND AWARDS

2024 **Early Career Award**, *Linguistic Society of America*

2023 **Best Paper Award**, *CogSci 2023*

2019 **His Majesty the King's Gold Medal**, *University of Oslo*
Awarded annually for an outstanding doctoral dissertation.

INVITED TALKS

2026 *Why paradigms survive.* Department of Linguistics colloquium, MIT, Cambridge, MA. March.
Learning without rules. Institute for Language Sciences, Utrecht University, NL. January.

2025 *Types, tokens and the productivity problem.* Keynote, Workshop on Morphological Learning, Leipzig, DE. September.
Negative evidence revisited. Centre for Language Evolution seminar, Edinburgh, UK. February.

2024 *What children do not learn.* Max Planck Institute for Psycholinguistics, Nijmegen, NL. November.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Halvorsen, M. A., & Reyes, D. (2026). Type frequency drives paradigm learning. *Boston University Conference on Language Development (BUCLD 50)*, Boston, MA. Talk.

Okonkwo, C., & **Halvorsen, M. A.** (2025). Compound stress across fourteen languages. *Annual Meeting of the LSA*, Philadelphia, PA. Poster.

Halvorsen, M. A. (2024). Overregularisation without rules. *CogSci 2024*, Rotterdam, NL. Talk.

Halvorsen, M. A., & Lindqvist, T. (2023). A learning bias for uniformity. *Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing (AMLaP)*, San Sebastián, ES. Poster.

TEACHING

University of Edinburgh

2023 – present **Language Acquisition (PSYL10112)**
Honours lecture course, 60–80 students. Designed and convened.

2022 – present **Research Methods in Cognitive Science (PSYL08004)**
First-year course, 240 students. Co-convened.

2024 – present **Computational Models of Learning (PSYL11045)**
M.Sc. seminar, 15 students.

University of Oslo

2016 – 2018 **Introduction to Phonology**
Teaching assistant; four semesters.

SUPERVISION

Ph.D.	D. Reyes (2023–, primary) · S. Bakhtiari (2024–, primary) · L. Fenwick (2022–, secondary)
M.Sc.	Eleven dissertations completed, 2022–2026
Honours	Nineteen projects completed, 2022–2026

SERVICE

To the Profession

Reviewing	*Cognition* · *Language* · *Journal of Memory and Language* · *Cognitive Science* · *Linguistic Typology* · NSF · ERC
Editorial	Associate Editor, *Glossa Psycholinguistics* (2025–present)
Organising	Programme Committee, AMLaP 2025 · Co-organiser, Workshop on Morphological Learning, Leipzig 2025

To the University

2024 – present	**Director of Postgraduate Admissions**, *PPLS*
2023 – present	**Member, School Ethics Committee**

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

Societies	Linguistic Society of America · Cognitive Science Society · Association for Laboratory Phonology

LANGUAGES AND TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages	Norwegian (native) · English (fluent) · German (fluent) · Dutch (reading)
Computing	R · Python · Praat · Praat scripting · Stan · LaTeX · Typst
Methods	Eye-tracking · EEG · Bayesian mixed-effects modelling · Corpus construction

REFERENCES

Available on request.